HOOK

JPMorgan just blocked outside AI agents

Not from the building. From the accounts.

- Agents like Meta's Muse are barred from touching bank accounts
- This isn't anti-AI. It's access control
- Same question is coming for your CRM

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Why this is blowing up right now

A major bank just made agent access a governance issue, publicly

- Banks hold the most sensitive read/write systems there are
- Letting any agent touch them was never going to be the default
- JPMorgan drew the boundary before a problem forced them to
- This is the first visible version of a decision every business faces

THE REAL SHIFT

The question changed

It used to be: which agents should we use?

- Now it's: which agents get access to revenue systems?
- Usage and access are two different decisions
- Most businesses have only thought about the first one
- CRM, billing, and email are the new 'accounts' to protect

MECHANISM

How access actually breaks down

Not all agent permissions are equal

- Read access: agent can view data, summarize, report
- Write access: agent can create, update, or delete records
- Action access: agent can trigger emails, payments, workflows
- Each level needs a different amount of trust and oversight

LESSON 1

Default to read-only, earn write access

The safest pattern for agents touching revenue data

- Start agents in observe-and-report mode
- Add write permissions only after the workflow is proven
- Keep a human approval step on anything irreversible
- This mirrors what JPMorgan just did at the account level

LESSON 2

Audit what's already connected

Most businesses don't know which tools can already write to their CRM

- Check integrations, Zapier/n8n connections, and API keys
- List what each one can read, write, or trigger
- Remove access that no one remembers granting
- This is basic hygiene, not paranoia

LESSON 3

Build guardrails into the workflow, not the vendor

Don't rely on an AI tool's internal safety promises

- Add validation steps before data hits your CRM
- Log every automated change for traceability
- Set retry and error handling instead of silent failures
- Guardrails belong in your architecture, not their marketing

TAKEAWAY

Map access before you map tools

The practical exercise worth doing this week

- List every system an agent could touch: CRM, email, calendar, billing
- Decide read, write, or action access for each one
- Document who approved that access and why
- Revisit the list every time you add a new automation

CTA

What can your automations actually touch?

Most teams have never mapped this out

- If you want a second pair of eyes on your access setup, let's talk
- Send me your current automation stack and I'll flag the risk points

Lark AI Agency | Paul Charles